WOLLEMIA NOBILIS · AOTEAROA NEW ZEALAND

Kauri's lost cousin, growing in New Zealand.

The Wollemi pine was known only from fossils until living trees were found in an Australian canyon in 1994. This is a New Zealand guide to what it is, how it grows here, and where you can stand next to one.

Find a Wollemi near you

Read the story



~200 million years

Age of the oldest fossils linked to its lineage.

1994

Found alive in Wollemi National Park, New South Wales.

2013

New Zealand's first, planted at Christchurch Botanic Gardens (NZ Tree Register).

THE TREE

A conifer everyone thought was extinct.

In 1994 a New South Wales parks ranger, David Noble, abseiled into a remote sandstone canyon and found a stand of trees no botanist could name. They turned out to be a third living branch of the Araucariaceae, the family that also holds New Zealand's kauri and the Norfolk Island pine.

Fewer than a hundred mature trees are known in the wild and the site is kept secret. Growing it in gardens around the world is part of the plan to keep the species alive.

Full story and botany

SPECIES	*Wollemia nobilis*
FAMILY	Araucariaceae
NZ RELATIVE	Kauri (*Agathis australis*)
NATIVE TO	Wollemi National Park, NSW
WILD STATUS	Critically Endangered
KNOWN FOR	Knobbly, bubbled dark bark

GROWING IN NZ

Written for our climate, not Sydney's.

Most care advice online assumes Australian or British conditions. These guides are organised around New Zealand regions and seasons.

By region

[TO WRITE: frost, wind and rainfall notes for Northland through Southland, from NZ growers' experience.]

Regional guide

Pot or ground

[TO WRITE: container size, potting mix, drainage, when to plant out, and how big it gets.]

Planting guide

When it sulks

[TO WRITE: browning tips, root problems, pests and other common questions, with photos.]

Troubleshooting

SEE ONE

The New Zealand specimen register.

A running list of Wollemi pines in public gardens and parks around the country. Know of one that's missing? Send it in.

Christchurch Botanic Gardens	Christchurch, Canterbury	Planted 2013 · first in NZ
[SPECIMEN LOCATION]	[TOWN, REGION]	[YEAR PLANTED]
[SPECIMEN LOCATION]	[TOWN, REGION]	[YEAR PLANTED]

Find a Wollemi near you

Submit a specimen

FIND A NURSERY

We don't sell trees. We point you to people who do.

This site has no shop and takes no commission. The list links to New Zealand nurseries that stock legitimately propagated Wollemi pines.

[NURSERY NAME]	[REGION · WEBSITE]
[NURSERY NAME]	[REGION · WEBSITE]
[NURSERY NAME]	[REGION · WEBSITE]

ABOUT THIS SITE

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